

Supervisor and Advisor Evaluations

Non-student observations of teaching

Applied Social and Health Psychology Program Coordinator Annual Review

Context: Annual review for the first year of graduate school.

He (Dr. Graham) also informed us of your extensive mentoring of undergraduate research assistants through their work in your lab and your weekly meetings with the team of URAs. This is a very beneficial practice for the students to develop as researchers and for your development as a mentor, and it is very impressive that you have begun doing all of this in your first year of graduate school.

Dr. Dan Graham: PSY 315 Social Psychology Guest Lecture

Advisor feedback after reviewing a recorded guest lecture.

I was able to watch Tuesday's class video this morning. Excellent job again!

I appreciate you including the additional information about exam corrections and answering student questions at the beginning of class. I had forgotten to mention again about the short answer questions, and I really appreciate you including that in your lecture!

I really liked how you asked the class to talk to neighbors for the direct effects of attraction question when it was taking a while to hear from anyone. I think that is a great approach to handling these questions where people are not engaging right away.

I also appreciate you adding cartoons and info from last week's grad social class to the slides to make them more fun!

And I loved that you added the summary slide at the end, where you asked the class to generate the four factors you had discussed in class today!

Really great job of incorporating strong science of learning-based practices into class again today Skylar!

Fall 2024 Classroom Observation

Observer: Dr. Dan Graham | Observation date: August 28, 2024

Skylar started today's class with questions for the group about the research process – lots of students got involved in this conversation. I thought the amount of time for this was appropriate – students had opportunities to think of and share answers, and Skylar did not provide information herself until students had had a chance to participate. I think it is a great practice to wait for students to respond before providing any information they haven't offered that you want to make sure is covered.

I liked that Skylar had students put up name tents in front of them, and noted on her clipboard who was speaking during class. One suggestion I would make would be to call on students by name. Skylar did this occasionally, and I would recommend doing this consistently.

I thought Skylar did an excellent job of incorporating students into the conversation in class – in discussing the research process, for example, she posed at least 10 questions and heard from just about all of the students in class in response to these questions. This pattern continued throughout class – she did a really top-notch job of promoting active learning by continuing to pose questions instead of lecturing for long stretches.

Skylar kept the amount of text on her slides to a minimum and I thought that was helpful for keeping students engaged throughout the class rather than reading what was on the screen while others were talking.

It is only week 2 of class, but already Skylar has established nice classroom norms and expectations that are helpful for moving from one activity to another very smoothly. When Skylar shifted from a discussion to a writing activity, there was not much need to introduce the activity and what the expectations were – students were quickly engaged and got right in to the writing without having wasted time in between the activities.

During small group discussion in class today, Skylar circulated around the classroom and interacted with the groups – listening to what they were talking about and answering questions. Everyone in the room was participating in these smaller group conversations and it seemed to me that Skylar's contributions to the small groups were helpful and clarified several issues that students were considering.

I also appreciated that Skylar gave the group a break during class with the explicit instruction to get up and move a bit – good for everyone's health and also their focus in class!

Skylar ended class with instructions for the activity students would be working on next and a plan for what would happen in the next class. I thought the amount of time devoted to this also seemed appropriate and sufficient to prepare students for what is to come. Doing this type of preparation for what is upcoming also helps students to keep each class session couched within the broader context of what is happening across the whole course. I thought everything was well structured today. Very nice job!